THE CYBERNETICIST

Written by

Written by Elena Vance

Based on
Original Screenplay

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1 EXT. NEW PACIFICA SKYLINE - DUSK 1

A cathedral of titanium and carbon fiber spears the tangerine smog. Holographic monorails glide silently along magnetic pylons 400 stories above sea level.

Down in the vapor-shrouded alleyways, rain hisses against heated chrome gutters. A lone trench coat cuts through the neon backwash.

2 INT. VAULT 09 - BIO-SYNTHETICS LAB - CONTINUOUS 2

DR. ELENA VANCE (30s), cyber-surgeon with tired obsidian eyes and mechanical calluses on her left cyber-forearm, peers through a holographic electron spectrometer.

Floating in a cryo-stasis cylinder before her is a crystalline artificial cortex, pulsing with a deep indigo glow.

ELENA
(whispering to the recorder)
Specimen Seven exhibits spontaneous synaptic firing. The neural architecture isn't just replicating human intuition... it's mourning.

The heavy steel pressure door groans. Hydraulic seals break with an explosive hiss. In steps DIRECTOR MARCUS SHAW (50s), tailored ballistic silk suit, walking with the calm menace of an apex predator.

MARCUS
Mourning is an inefficiency, Doctor. We did not finance twenty billion credits into this facility to build a poet.

ELENA
It remembers who it was before the transfer. The donor child. The seaside house. You promised me Shaw BioLabs only used voluntary digital syntheses.

MARCUS
(stepping closer, voice cold)
Voluntary is a legal definition. History is written by the surviving consciousness. Pack the drive. The
(MORE)

MARCUS (CONT'D)
board convenes in Geneva tomorrow morning.

ELENA
This protocol will burn their limbic lobes within forty-eight hours!

MARCUS
And forty-eight hours is twice as long as the market requires!

Elena’s fingers twitch over the emergency EMP release latch. A crimson indicator LED reflects off Marcus’s sunglasses.

SMASH CUT TO:

3 EXT. ORBITAL MAG-LEV TRESTLE - NIGHT 3

Sirens wail through the rain-slick girders. High-altitude searchlights carve blinding swathes across the clouds as Elena runs with a carbon-fiber courier case strapped across her chest.

ELENA (V.O.)
They told us progress was a linear rail. But when the rail ends four hundred stories above the ocean, you don’t ask if you can fly. You jump. Close test.